

509_{BCE} – 476_{CE}

ROMAN EMPIRE

Dress was carefully prescribed in Roman society, especially for men; rank and status determined whether the toga could be worn (only by Roman citizens) and whether it might be coloured. Only the emperor could wear purple, but priests, senators, and equestrians (serving in the army or the administration) might wear a stripe of purple on their robes. A women's basic garment was the *stola*, which hung in pleats from the shoulders, where it fastened with brooches or clasps called *fibulae* and was often held in under the bust and around the waist with a belt. Over this, ladies wore a *palla* (shawl), which might cover the head. Madder (red), saffron (yellow), and indigo (blue) dyes were available, and clothes were sometimes embroidered. Most garments were wool or linen, but silk was imported for the wealthy. Foreign captives and slaves wore a simple *tunica* (tunic). Leather sandals or boots protected the feet.

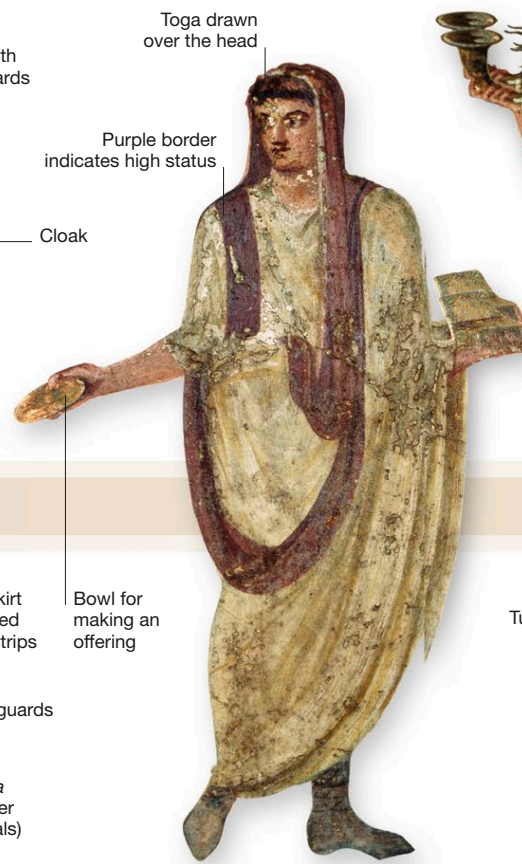
HAIRSTYLES



Hairstyling was important for both men and women, and hair fashions changed often. During the Imperial period (27_{BCE}–3_{CE}) styles became increasingly elaborate, particularly for the nobility. Men generally kept their hair short and neat, and were clean shaven. Wealthy women had slaves to help them curl and dress their hair using ointments and *calamistrum* (curling irons). To create styles such as the raised curls above, hair pieces or wigs were used, sometimes made with blonde hair from Germanic peoples.



Roman soldier Wearing a leather cuirass, this reconstructed legionary has a metal helmet and shinguards to protect him in battle. His woollen cloak was also a blanket.



Draped figure In this fresco from a household shrine in Pompeii, the master of the house is offering a sacrifice. His priestly function is marked by draping the purple-bordered toga praetexta over his head.



Dancing spirit This *lar* is a mythological figure who protects the household. His tunic is tucked up in a simple rustic style. It is bound at the waist with a girdle.

